IT Support Knowledge Base

Reference articles for the self-service triage agent — common office IT issues, resolution steps, and escalation criteria

1. Wi-Fi Connectivity Issues

Symptoms: device shows connected but no internet access, Wi-Fi network not visible, or frequent disconnects.

Suggested steps:

1. Restart the device's Wi-Fi adapter (toggle Wi-Fi off and on)
2. Forget the network and reconnect, re-entering the password
3. Move closer to the access point and check if other devices have the same issue
4. Restart the device

Escalate if: the issue affects multiple people in the same area (possible access point failure), or persists after all steps above.

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2. VPN Connection Problems

Symptoms: VPN client fails to connect, connects but drops shortly after, or blocks access to internal resources.

Suggested steps:

1. Confirm the device has a working internet connection outside the VPN first
2. Fully quit and restart the VPN client
3. Check the VPN client is on the latest version
4. Restart the device and reattempt the connection

Escalate if: credentials are confirmed correct but the connection is still refused, or the VPN service appears down for multiple users.

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3. Printer Not Working or Not Found

Symptoms: printer does not appear in the device's printer list, print jobs stay queued, or print quality is poor.

Suggested steps:

1. Confirm the printer is powered on and connected to the network
2. Remove and re-add the printer on the affected device
3. Restart the print spooler service on the device
4. Try printing a test page directly from the printer's own panel

Escalate if: the printer is unreachable from multiple devices (likely a network or hardware fault), or shows a persistent error code on its own display.

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4. Password Reset or Account Lockout

Symptoms: login rejected despite correct password, account locked after multiple attempts, or password expired.

Suggested steps:

1. Verify Caps Lock and keyboard layout are not affecting the input
2. Use the self-service password reset link if available
3. Wait the standard lockout cooldown period before retrying

Escalate immediately if: the account shows signs of unauthorized access, or self-service reset is unavailable and access is time-critical.

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5. Slow Computer Performance

Symptoms: device is noticeably slower than usual, applications take a long time to open, or the system frequently freezes.

Suggested steps:

1. Restart the device (resolves most temporary slowdowns)
2. Check for and close unnecessary applications running in the background
3. Confirm available storage space is not critically low
4. Check for pending system or antivirus updates

Escalate if: performance issues persist after a restart and free storage is confirmed adequate, as this may indicate a hardware issue.

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6. Application Crashes or Freezes

Symptoms: a specific application closes unexpectedly, becomes unresponsive, or fails to open.

Suggested steps:

1. Restart the application
2. Check whether an update is available for the application
3. Restart the device
4. Try opening the application in a new user profile or as administrator, if applicable

Escalate if: the crash happens consistently and blocks time-sensitive work, or affects multiple users with the same application.

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7. Email / Outlook Sync Issues

Symptoms: new emails not arriving, sent items stuck in the outbox, or calendar not updating.

Suggested steps:

1. Confirm the device has an active internet connection
2. Restart the email client
3. Check the account's connection status in the client's account settings
4. Sign out and back into the email account

Escalate if: the issue affects the mail server broadly (multiple users report the same symptom), or persists after re-authentication.

8. Microphone or Camera Not Working in Meetings

Symptoms: microphone or camera not detected, no audio/video during a call, or permission errors.

Suggested steps:

1. Check the meeting app has permission to access the microphone/camera in system settings
2. Confirm the correct device is selected in the meeting app's audio/video settings
3. Close other applications that might be using the microphone or camera
4. Restart the device

Escalate if: the hardware does not appear in system settings at all, which may indicate a driver or hardware fault.